The day before the famous 438 ODI game against Australia at the Wanderers in 2006, I got totally wasted. Which, given my performance the next day, scoring 175 off 111 balls to help the Proteas chase down Australia's record-breaking total of 434, probably comes as a surprise to most people.

We had a team practice the morning before the game and were given the afternoon off. I took the opportunity to fit in a signing session for my long-time bat, pads, and gloves sponsor Gunn & Moore. Two kids were among those standing in line – two brothers aged somewhere between 10 and 12 – both eager for my signature. Who really caught my eye, though, was their mom, one of those real Joburg yummy-mummies. We're talking proper quality here.

'Gee,' I said to the one boy, 'is that your mother? Ask her to come and say hi.' Obviously the kids were overawed and far too young to put two and two together. They introduced their mom to me in a flash. As it happened, she was going through a divorce at the time. I thought, 'Well, okay, cool, let me just see what happens here.' I invited the mommy to join me for a few drinks. She said yes, and we started drinking some white wine. This must've been around 2 p.m. We sat at the bar on the sixth floor of the Sandton Sun Hotel until about 6 p.m., when I had to attend a Proteas team meeting.

You're probably thinking, 'Four hours of drinking and then he goes to a team meeting? Surely they must've noticed that he was drunk? And that can't be a good thing, right?' Fortunately I can handle my drink pretty well – up to a point, obviously – and often I might be a little tipsy, but people won't know. Probably because of years of experience. Besides, we'd had something to eat that afternoon as well, so it wasn't just wine on its own *all* the time. I made it through the team meeting without getting any raised eyebrows.

So, afterwards, I met up with the woman again and we carried on drinking. We were getting on really well too, even making plans for her two boys to have playdates with my son Rashard. This carried on until 11 p.m., when the mommy and I went up to my room. I must've been pretty drunk by then, because from that moment on the evening is a bit of a blank. Apparently the Aussie team management was also at the bar and they could see the whole drama unfolding.